

NT46 Enrichment

E1. Introduction and Timeline for Revelation 4-11:

“Following his vision of the Savior and his letters to the seven churches (see Revelation 1–3), John wrote about his visions concerning “things which must be hereafter” (Revelation 4:1). In the first of John’s visions that are recorded in Revelation 4–11, he saw God the Father enthroned in heaven, exalted beings who worship Him, and a book sealed with seven seals. John saw that the One who could open the book was Jesus Christ. John saw visions associated with the opening of the first six seals of the book, which symbolize the earth’s first six thousand years of temporal existence.

“In spite of the plagues and judgments that would come upon the earth’s inhabitants in the last days, John saw that those who were washed clean through the blood of the Lamb would be spared many of the destructions. John also recorded that prior to Christ’s Second Coming, two prophets would be slain in Jerusalem and then resurrected after three and a half days. Doctrine and Covenants 77 records the Lord’s answers to 15 key questions that help unlock some of the symbolism in chapters 4–11 of Revelation.” (*New Testament Student Manual*, [Chapter 54: Revelation 4-11](#) at lds.org.)

E2. Commentary for Revelation 4-11, Revelation 4:1 “Things Which Must Be Hereafter”

Gerald N. Lund, who later served as a member of the Seventy, gave an overview of John’s visions in Revelation 4-22 and explained some of their basic meanings:

“The basic structure of the vision is chronological. After seeing the Father and the Son in heaven (Rev. 4–5), the vision of the history and destiny of the world begin to unfold for John. He sees the first five seals (or first five thousand years of history) in rapid-fire, in encapsulated form. Then he sees the opening of the sixth seal, which includes the restoration of the gospel. (See Rev. 6:12–7:17.)

“After that, John sees the seventh period of a thousand years, with great judgments poured out upon the earth, including Armageddon (see Rev. 8–9, 11, 16), which eventually lead to the utter overthrow of Babylon (see 17–18) and make way for the second coming of him who is King of kings and Lord of lords (see 19). Immediately following that, John sees Satan bound and Christ reigning for a thousand years (see 20:1–6), a last great battle between the forces of righteousness and evil (see 20:7–10), and the final judgment (see 20:11–15). Finally, a new heaven and a new earth are brought forth. (See 21:1–22:5.)” ([“Seeing the Book of Revelation as a Book of Revelation,”](#) *Ensign*, Dec. 1987, 52).

E3. Introduction and Timeline for Revelation 17-22:

“The final chapters of Revelation gave hope to Christians facing persecution from outside the Church and from factions within the Church that were dissenting from accepted beliefs. Revelation 17–22 also describes the crescendo of final earthly events fulfilling Heavenly Father’s plan for the redemption of His children. John heard heavenly servants rejoice in praise for the salvation made possible through the Lamb’s triumph over evil. John saw the fall of wicked Babylon contrasted with the glories of the Second Coming and the blessings of exaltation for all those who follow God’s commands. John further saw that the righteous inhabitants of the earth and those who will come forth in the First Resurrection will enjoy a thousand years of millennial peace with Christ. The earth will then receive celestial glory and become the eternal home for all righteous Saints.” (*New Testament Student Manual*, [Chapter 55: Revelation 17-22](#) at lds.org.)

E4. Commentary for Revelation 17-22, Revelation 17-18. The Fall of Babylon

“In Revelation 16:17, the seventh angel poured out his vial, signaling the final destructive events that will precede the Second Coming of Jesus Christ. These concluding events include the fall of Babylon, described in Revelation 17–18. Ancient Babylon had destroyed Jerusalem in 587 B.C., a traumatic and defining event in Israel’s history. Israelite prophets in turn wrote about the eventual destruction of Babylon (see Isaiah 13:19–22; 21:9; Jeremiah 50:35–36, 40; 51:6–8), and John drew upon their language as he described the ultimate destruction of the spiritual enemies of God’s people.

“In Rev. 14:8; 16:19; 17:5; 18:2, 10, 21, Babylon probably denotes Rome, the great antagonist of Messiah’s kingdom” (Bible Dictionary, “Babylon or Babel”). It is likely that Babylon also represents all that is wicked in the world (see D&C 1:16; 133:14). Chapters 17–18 depict Babylon as a “whore” holding a cup “full of abominations and filthiness” and as the “mother of harlots” (Revelation 17:1, 4, 5). In this sense, Babylon is the antitype of the righteous bride that represents the Church (see Revelation 19:7–8) and the antithesis of Zion as “the pure in heart” (D&C 97:21). John’s vision of Babylon parallels much of Nephi’s vision of the great and abominable church (see 1 Nephi 13:4–9, 26–29; 14:3–17; 22:13–16, 18).” (*New Testament Student Manual*, [Chapter 55: Revelation 17-22](#) at lds.org.)

E5. The New Jerusalem

The glorious new dwelling of the righteous, the New Jerusalem, will have light like unto jasper (21:11), walls of jasper (21:18), and the first foundation made of jasper (20:19). Where I live, our foundations are typically made of concrete, and although they are vital, they are the ugliest part of the building. The very bottom foundation of this city is made of jasper, a beautiful precious stone. The city is so glorious that gems and precious stones are all John can find in our world to describe it!



"Jasper is a mixture of quartz and iron oxide...[It] is harder than a knife and scratches glass. It takes a high polish, is used for mantels, pillars and other fancy interior finishings. Fine grades of jasper are polished into gems. Jasper was found on the breastplate of the High Priest in Exodus. Greeks and Romans believed it could heal many illnesses and draw the poison from snake bites." (*World Book Encyclopedia*) (Nancy Jensen, [New Testament Lesson #46 "He Will Dwell with Them, and They Shall Be His People"](#), LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus, December 3, 2011.)

E6. Elder Steven E. Snow: "“Hope is an emotion which brings richness to our everyday lives. It is defined as “the feeling that ... events will turn out for the best.” When we exercise hope, we “look forward ... with desire and reasonable confidence” (dictionary.reference.com/browse/hope). As such, hope brings a certain calming influence to our lives as we confidently look forward to future events...

“We should never let hope be displaced by despair. The Apostle Paul wrote that we “‘should plow in hope’ (1 Corinthians 9:10). The exercise of hope enriches our lives and helps us look forward to the future. Whether we are plowing fields to plant or plowing through life, it is imperative we, as Latter-day Saints, have hope.

“In the gospel of Jesus Christ, hope is the desire of His followers to gain eternal salvation through the Atonement of the Savior...

“Our hope in the Atonement empowers us with eternal perspective. Such perspective allows us to look beyond the here and now on into the promise of the eternities. We don’t have to be trapped in the narrow confines of society’s fickle expectations. We are free to look forward to celestial glory, sealed to our family and loved ones.” (“[Hope](#),” *Ensign*, May 2011)

E7. Elder David O. McKay: “We should put forth every effort to supplant the aristocracy of wealth with the aristocracy of character and awaken in the minds of the youth a realization that to be honest, to be dependable, to be a loyal citizen of the country, to be true to the standards of the Gospel, are the noblest ideals of life.” (In [Conference Report](#), Oct. 3, 1930)

Additional Idea

1. The dangers of setting our hearts on worldly possessions

A• Rev. 18:10-18 “And the merchants of the earth shall weep and mourn”

“The wicked will mourn the loss of their worldly possessions and be amazed that a great worldly kingdom could be destroyed in a brief time.” (*Lesson Manual*)†7. Elder David O. McKay

When have you seen worldly possessions destroyed or lost in a brief amount of time?

What are the dangers of setting our hearts on worldly things?

Recommended Conference Talks:

1. Neil L. Andersen, “[Preparing the World for the Second Coming](#),” Apr. 2011 General Conference.
2. Steven E. Snow, “[Hope](#),” Apr. 2011 General Conference.

Recommended Reading:

1. Daniel Rona, at LDSGospelDoctrine.net. Select 2015 NT. Select 2011 NT GD46. Select Daniel Rona Israel Revealed GD supplement.
2. Nancy Jensen, [New Testament Lesson #46 "He Will Dwell with Them, and They Shall Be His People"](#), LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus, December 3, 2011.
3. Lenet Read, at LDSGospelDoctrine.net. Select 2015 NT. Select 2011 NT GD46. Select Lenet Read Gospel Doctrine lesson outlines.
4. Gerald Smith, [New Testament Gospel Doctrine Lesson 44: "He Will Dwell with Them, and They Shall Be His People" Revelation 5-22](#), Joel's Monastery, November 29, 2011.
5. Monte Shelley, at LDSGospelDoctrine.net), Monte Shelley GD Lesson Notes. Select 2015 NT. Select 46) Revelation 5-6, 19-22. Select Monte Shelley GD Lesson Notes.

Visit stephenmbird.com